

Doubly Linked List – Memory Allocation

```
Node *newNode = (Node *)malloc(sizeof(Node));
```

→ *The size of newNode will be equal to the size of a Node structure and newNode is declared as a pointer to Node structure.*

→ *The size of a pointer (newNode) is typically 8 bytes on most modern 64 – bit systems, regardless of the size of the structure it points to.*

→ *The size of the Node structure itself is determined by the sum of the sizes of its members:*

→ *data(an integer) is typically 4 bytes.*

→ *next(a pointer to another Node) is typically 8 bytes.*

→ *prev(a pointer to previous Node) is typically 8 bytes.*

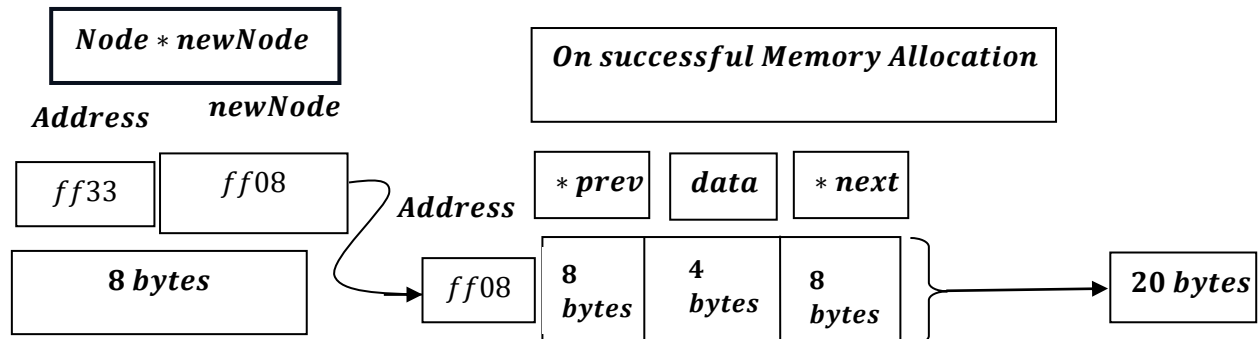
→ *Therefore ,the size of the Node structure is typically 20 bytes(4 bytes for data + 8 bytes for next + 8 bytes for prev) .*

```
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```

What does it mean?

→ *newNode will try to allocate memory for data i.e. 4 bytes ,next pointer variable i.e. typically 8 bytes, and prev pointer variable that is typically 8 bytes i.e. total 20 bytes, as discussed earlier , the size of a pointer (newNode) is typically 8 bytes on most modern 64 – bit systems, regardless of the size of the structure it points to.*

Say,



The above is Theoretical , But if we do a reality check:

Theoretical vs. Real – World Allocation

In a real programming environment (like the C ++ environments),

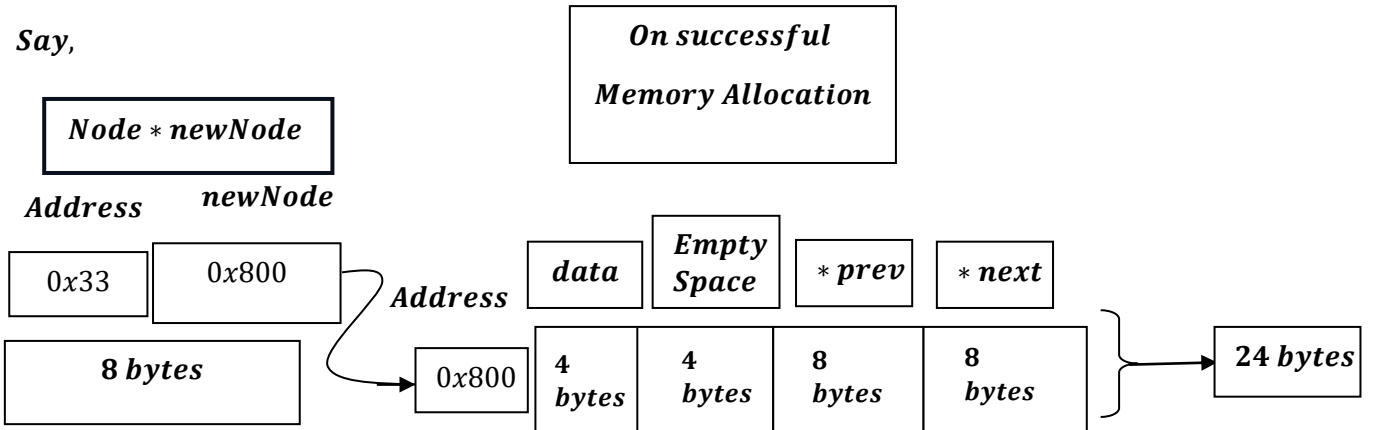
*the allocation might not be exactly **20 bytes** because of how CPUs access memory:*

- **Memory Alignment:** Most 64 – bit compilers align data to **8 – byte boundaries** to improve performance.
- **Padding:** To align the 8 – byte `next` pointer, the compiler will often add **4 bytes of "padding"** after the 4 – byte `data` integer.

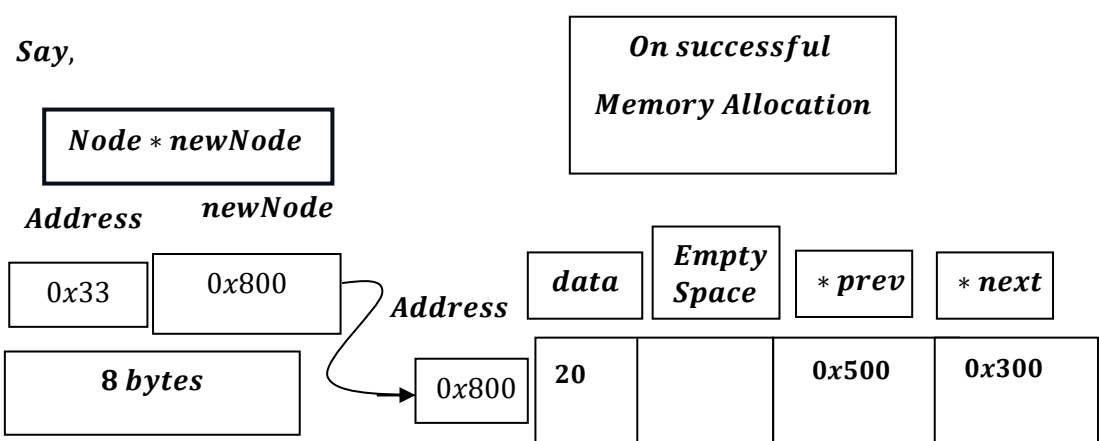
Additionally, since there is another 8 – byte pointer (`prev`), the structure must maintain proper alignment for both pointers.

- **Actual Size:** Consequently, `sizeof(Node)` would likely return **24 bytes** on your system, rather than the theoretical **20 bytes**.

<i>Offset</i>	<i>Size</i>	<i>Content</i>	<i>Description</i>
0	4 bytes	<i>data</i>	<i>Integer value</i>
4	4 bytes	<i>padding</i>	<i>Empty space (alignment)</i>
8	8 bytes	<i>next</i>	<i>Address of next node</i>
16	8 bytes	<i>prev</i>	<i>Address of previous node</i>



Like:



In a 64 – bit environment, the compiler aligns memory to the size of the largest primitive member in a structure – in this case, the 8 – byte next pointer.

Because the data integer only occupies 4 bytes, the compiler inserts empty space (padding) to ensure the pointer starts at an address that is a multiple of 8.

Such as:

$$0x500 = 5 \times 16^2 + 0 \times 16^1 + 0 \times 16^0 = 5 \times 256 = 1280$$

$$1280 \div 8 = 160 \text{ (no remainder)}$$

$$0x300 = 3 \times 16^2 + 0 \times 16^1 + 0 \times 16^0 = 3 \times 256 = 768$$

$$768 \div 8 = 96 \text{ (no remainder)}$$
